# The Alpine Memories

Aurelia: When the cold wind rises, the mist clears from the northern peaks. I still remember the high stone steps of Tower I, the great brass dome turning in absolute silence, and the long winter nights we spent reading the stars together beside the fire.



Tower I: The Alpine Observatory. The telescope slit faced Polaris through the longest winter nights.



Leontopodium nivale
High crags · alt. 2400 varas

Aurelia: This little white flower blooms in the deep rock fissures near the summit. Its petals are as soft as wool, shielding the tiny seed from the alpine frost. We pressed one into the pages of our Astrolabe log on the twenty-third day of September. If you climb high enough, the snow remembers every single footstep.

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Hermes: She is beginning to remember the way back. The road to the peaks is still open.

